CHAPTER 01 · INTRODUCTION

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The pilot worked. That is precisely the problem.

Somewhere in your organisation an AI pilot worked. Processing time fell, quality rose, the board was pleased. Six months later it is still a pilot: the gain is invisible in the P&L, the licence costs are not.

Ask the executive table why, and you hear nine sincere answers. The CFO sees licences before evidence, the COO an operation that cannot pause, the CIO shadow AI and agents without owners, HR a fear no communication plan reaches. Procurement watches lock-in signed before value, Supply Chain a forecast nobody trusts, and business units lose their best people while the benefits are claimed centrally.

Each explanation is locally true — so each fix is only partly effective. Finance tightens funding and pilots slow; IT tightens governance and shadow AI goes underground.

> **The pilot is not failing. The organisation around it is not built to absorb it.**
>
> CHAPTER 1

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ✔ A successful pilot does not prove the enterprise is ready to scale.
- ✔ Nine locally true explanations point to one shared cause.
- ✔ Fixing symptoms one corner at a time leaves the condition untouched.